Alina *Acosta*-Romay

DIRECTOR OF OPERATIONS & PEOPLE

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Available immediately · EN / FR / ES

PROFILE

Operations and people leader with **10+ years** building systems, processes, and organizational infrastructure in SME, nonprofit, and startup environments — **from scratch.**

I find what is broken, build what is missing, and stay long enough to make sure it works.

CORE SKILLS

Operations

- Systems Design
- Process Documentation
- Policy Development
- Vendor Management
- Tool Implementation

Finance

- Budgeting & Forecasting
- Financial Controls
- P&L Management
- Reporting Automation
- Grant & Funder Reporting

People & HR

- Team Leadership
- Recruitment & Onboarding
- Performance Management
- Culture-Building
- Training & Development

Compliance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

General Manager
Apr 2024 – May 2025

Nature Expert · Montreal, QC

Quebec's leading specialty birding retailer — $1.8M revenue, 5-person team, 700+ SKUs. Owner absent 8+ months. No documented processes, no operational infrastructure.

- Built and ran the full organizational infrastructure independently during an 8+ month leadership gap — staff scheduling, supplier management, inventory governance, order fulfillment, and financial decision-making simultaneously with **zero disruptions.**
- Led a 5-person team through a period of sustained uncertainty — managed scheduling, performance conversations, conflict resolution, and day-to-day culture with no executive oversight.
- Recruited, onboarded, and trained a replacement manager from scratch — built the documentation, process playbooks, and knowledge transfer system for a clean handoff.
- Built operational processes where none existed: buying cadences, supplier protocols, fulfillment workflows, and financial reporting templates — took the business from systems in the owner's head to **repeatable, transferable infrastructure.**
- Cut fulfillment costs **33% ($39K/year)** by rebuilding the cost model and renegotiating carrier rates.
- Stopped a 4-year revenue decline — both 2024 and 2025 showed growth.

Growth & Financial Strategy Consultant
Jul 2025 – Feb 2026

Nature Expert · Montreal, QC

Returned to build financial infrastructure and complete the strategic growth plan.

- Produced a full organizational diagnostic across 7 documents — 4-year financial analysis, 67-idea strategic matrix, and 6-engine growth model — synthesized into a **3-year roadmap targeting $1.8M → $2.85M revenue.**
- Rebuilt 4 years of monthly P&Ls from bank ledgers — corrected misclassifications, surfaced true profitability by category, channel, and SKU for the first time.

Data Governance | Risk Management | Employment Standards | Regulatory Compliance

Tools

Excel (Advanced) | Power BI | QuickBooks | HubSpot / Salesforce | Trello | Google Workspace | Shopify | Tableau

LANGUAGES

English	Native
French	Professional
Spanish	Native

EDUCATION

MA, Economics (30 credits)
University of Ottawa · 2014–2017

BA Honours, Economics — Top 10%
University of Calgary · 2013

BA, International Relations
University of Calgary · 2013

HACCP Certification · Google Ads Certified

COMMUNITY

Queer woman, parent of a transyouth, and loving support system to many 2SLGBTQIA+ people.

Built reporting automation reducing P&L compilation from 25–30 hrs to 5–6 hrs (**80% reduction**) — enabling monthly reviews instead of annual.

Designed Open-to-Buy inventory governance system — identified **~$150K annual gross profit improvement;** delivered as ready-to-implement framework.

Identified **$600K+** in recoverable revenue across pricing, shipping policy, conversion, dead stock, and idle capital.

Business Development Manager — Quebec & Nunavut

Mar – Jun 2025

CQCC – Canadian Queer Chamber of Commerce · Montreal, QC

Grant-funded nonprofit serving 2SLGBTQI+ business owners across Canada — mission-driven, bilingual, accountability-driven.

Led Supplier Diversity Certification program in Quebec & Nunavut — **surpassed enrollment targets,** onboarding 8 new 2SLGBTQI+ entrepreneurs.

Delivered bilingual (EN/FR) coaching to SME founders on operations, pricing, go-to-market strategy, and revenue growth.

Tracked program deliverables, managed reporting timelines, and aligned activities to funder compliance requirements.

Founder & Product Developer

May 2018 – Mar 2025

Nutality Foods Inc. · Montreal, QC

Built 3 CPG product lines from formulation through retail distribution — 13+ SKUs, 40+ retail accounts, full supply chain and operations.

Managed a distributed network of external collaborators — food scientists, co-manufacturers, regulatory consultants, packaging designers, retail buyers — coordinating timelines and compliance with no formal team structure.

Built all internal systems from scratch: financial tracking, vendor governance, inventory management, pricing models, and regulatory compliance documentation.

Tested initial brand in-store; identified positioning mismatch through direct consumer observation; rebuilt brand identity from scratch — validated before relaunch. **Systems-thinking applied to real commercial risk.**

Raised **$85K** through validated investor pitch decks; built distribution from **0 to 40+ retail accounts.**

Market Research & Project Officer

Feb 2017 – May 2018

Trade Facilitation Office of Canada (TFO) · Ottawa, ON

Nonprofit funded by Global Affairs Canada — delivering trade facilitation programs to international SMEs.

Produced bilingual market entry reports tied directly to federal funding mandates and program outcome reporting — operated within grant

accountability frameworks standard to the sector.

Facilitated B2B trade partnerships at SIAL Montreal 2018; analyzed market data using Excel, Tableau, and Power BI.

EARLIER ROLES

International Market Expansion Manager
The Rainforest Company · Ottawa · 2016–2017
0 → 40+ B2B accounts; 4 → 30+ SKUs; CFIA compliance

Economic Energy Advisor
Embassy of Korea to Canada · Ottawa · 2015–2016

Business Development Manager
Allied Scientific Pro · Gatineau · 2014–2015
Top conversion on technical sales team; opened museum/gallery market segment

Co-Founder
Farms To You Canada · Calgary · 2006–2008
Wholesale flower distribution; Walmart, Co-Op, 250+ florists

Download Resume (PDF)